An Overview of Python Container Methods

Check out Python's documetation for the different containers to learn more about these and other methods.

List Methods

Method	Purpose	Returns	Mutates list?
append(x)	Adds item x to the end of the list	None	Yes
extend(iter)	Appends all items from an iterable to the end of the list	None	Yes
insert(i,x)	Inserts item x at specified index i	None	Yes
remove(x)	Removes first occurrence of value x (raises ValueError if missing)	None	Yes
pop(i)	Removes and returns item at index i (default is last item -1)	Item	Yes
clear()	Removes all items from the list	None	Yes
index(x)	Returns zero-based index of first occurrence of x (raises ValueError if missing)	Integer	No
count(x)	Returns total number of times x appears in the list	Integer	No
sort()	Sorts list elements in-place (supports optional key and reverse)	None	Yes
reverse()	Reverses order of list elements in-place	None	Yes
copy()	Returns a shallow copy of the list	New list	No

Dict methods

Method	Purpose	Returns	Mutates dict?
get(key, default)	Returns value for key if present; otherwise returns default (None if omitted)	Value or default	No
keys()	Provides a dynamic view object of all dictionary keys	dict_keys view	No
values()	Provides a dynamic view object of all dictionary values	dict_values view	No
items()	Provides a dynamic view object of all (key, value) tuples	dict_items view	No

Method	Purpose	Returns	Mutates dict?
update(other)	Updates dict with key-value pairs from another dict or iterable of pairs	None	Yes
pop(key, default)	Removes key and returns its value (returns default or raises KeyError if missing)	Value of key	Yes
popitem()	Removes and returns the last-inserted (key, value) pair	tuple (key, value)	Yes
setdefault(key, default)	Returns value if key exists; if missing, inserts key with default and returns default	Value or default	Yes (if key missing)
clear()	Removes all key-value pairs from the dictionary	None	Yes
copy()	Returns a shallow copy of the dictionary	dict (new copy)	No
fromkeys(iterable, val)	Creates a new dictionary with keys from iterable and values set to val	dict (new dict)	No

Set methods

Method	Purpose	Returns	Mutates set?
add(elemnet)	Adds element elem to the set	None	Yes
update(others)	Adds all elements from one or more iterables to the set	None	Yes
remove(element)	Removes element from set (raises KeyError if missing)	None	Yes
discard(element)	Safely removes element from set if present (no error if missing)	None	Yes
pop()	Removes and returns an arbitrary element (raises KeyError if empty)	Removed element	Yes
clear()	Removes all elements from the set	None	Yes
copy()	Returns a shallow copy of the set	set (new copy)	No
union(others)	Returns a new set with elements from current set and all others	set (new set)	No
intersection(others)	Returns a new set with elements common to current set and all others	set (new set)	No

Method	Purpose	Returns	Mutates set?
difference(others)	Returns a new set with elements in current set but not in others	set (new set)	No
symmetric_difference(other)	Returns a new set with elements in either set, but not both	set (new set)	No
intersection_update(others)	Updates set in-place, keeping only elements present in all sets	None	Yes
difference_update(others)	Updates set in-place, removing elements found in specified sets.	None	Yes
symmetric_difference_update(other)	Updates set in-place, keeping elements in either set, but not both	None	Yes
isdisjoint(other)	Returns True if two sets share zero elements	bool	No
issubset(other)	Returns True if every element of current set is in other	bool	No
issuperset(other)	Returns True if every element of other is in current set	bool	No